

FIELD LIBRARY / ACTION CHECKLIST

Thunderstorm

NATURAL HAZARDS / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Go inside a substantial building or a fully enclosed hard-top vehicle when thunder is heard. Stay away from windows and monitor warnings for damaging wind, hail, tornadoes and flash flooding.

Do now.

- ☐ **Get indoors**
01 Open shelters, tents and trees do not protect from lightning.
- ☐ **Avoid conductive paths**
02 Inside, avoid plumbing and plugged-in equipment during lightning.
- ☐ **Read new warnings**
03 Move to an interior room for severe wind or hail; use a tornado shelter if a tornado warning is issued.
- ☐ **Wait before returning**
04 After the last thunder, wait at least 30 minutes before resuming outdoor activity.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Use a substantial building or enclosed hard-top vehicle even when warnings cannot be checked. Avoid plumbing and wired electrical equipment during lightning. Watch for rising water and damaging wind without going outside to observe the storm.

Watch for.

Every thunderstorm can produce lightning, even without a severe thunderstorm warning.

People & practical needs.

Account for children, older people, pets and anyone who needs assistance before moving. Keep shoes, medicines and a torch in the shelter area

Next decision.

Check for downed lines and flooded routes before travel. Schedule outdoor work around forecasts.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

Thunderstorm · official guidance

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/thunderstorm/>